

WHIDBEY ISLAND HORSE COUNCIL
MEETING MINUTES
3/4/2026

The meeting was called to order by coordinator Sally Garratt at 6:30pm. It was conducted both in person and by zoom. Ten people were present (3 on zoom). The minutes from the last meeting were reviewed and approved.

County Comp Plan: the submissions to the County by Paula and Sally were discussed. County Parks is requesting comments to their Plan and Paula will submit comments.

The Equine Economics Impact Survey is moving forward with 250 equine interested people now on a list to contact. Leslie reported about the effort in Kitsap County to limit horse ownership. The Kitsap horse owners said that they got people involved because of the “galvanizing” issue (the proposed code revision) but otherwise, they felt that horse owners don’t want attention. Betsy proposed an “action plan” that would include creating a brief postcard message about the HC, proposed rules for the contact list, a FB page, coordinating with WIEN (and their 2500 members). The admin for WIEN may be leaving and we will contact them to see what their plans are for the group. Karina will develop a new FB group for the HC. Peggy will work on creating a logo for the HC to use on the FB page and other communication.

No information was reported regarding the Horse Directory. Sally will try to follow up with Thora.

Peggy has been involved with developing a Island wide emergency plan for large animals. She has attended the South Whidbey Prepares meetings and will follow their work including the development of a preparedness manual.

Large animal rescue was discussed. Barb will follow up with Jerry Lloyd regarding what is being done.

The next meeting will be held at 6:30pm on April 1, 2026 at the Race Road Fire station and on Zoom.